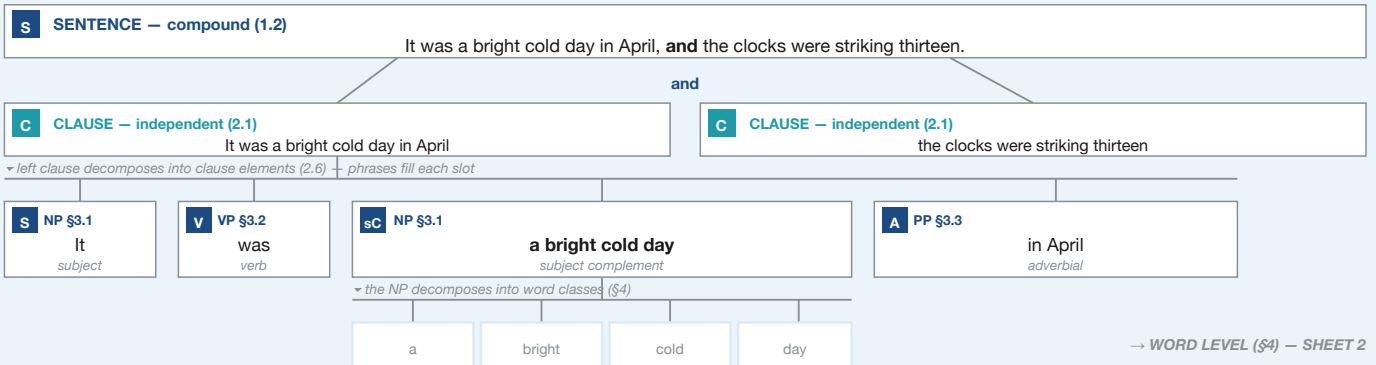


1 THE NESTED HIERARCHY — SENTENCE › CLAUSE › PHRASE

worked example — Orwell, 1984 (§1.2)



Orwell, "1984" (1.2). Bold = the item each level's decomposition targets. The right-hand clause decomposes the same way.

"in April" is read here as a clause-level adverbial (2.6); it may alternatively be analysed as a postmodifier inside the NP "a bright cold day in April" (3.1).

Labelled bracketing (1.2), same sentence, compact notation: [S [NP It] [VP [V was] [NP a bright cold day] [PP in April]]]

2 SENTENCE LEVEL

§1 — the highest level of organisation

BY CLAUSE STRUCTURE (1.1–1.6)

- Simple** — one independent clause (1.1) ◦ "Call me Ishmael." (Melville)
- Compound** — 2+ independent, coordinated or punctuation-joined (1.2)
- Complex** — independent + one or more dependent clauses (1.3)
- Compound-complex** — 2+ independent + dependent (1.4)
- Punctuation-joined** — semicolon/colon/dash, no conjunction (1.5)
- Mixed** — coordination + subordination + punctuation together (1.6)

COORDINATION (1.2) vs SUBORDINATION (1.3):

IC	and / but / or	IC
----	----------------	----

same level — coordination

BY PURPOSE (1.7)

- Declarative** — makes a statement or opinion
- Interrogative** — asks a direct question
- Imperative** — command, request, instruction (→5.7.6)
- Exclamatory** — strong emotion, surprise, emphasis
- Tag question** — reversed-polarity tag repeats aux + pronoun
- "It's a nice day, *isn't it?*"

IC

dependent clause

hangs below

3 CLAUSE LEVEL

§2 — every clause = subject + predicate

CORE TYPES

- Independent** — stands alone (2.1)
- Dependent** — attaches to an independent clause (2.2)
- Noun clause** — noun function: subj/obj/complement (2.3)
- Adverbial** — modifies V/Adj/Adv: time, reason, condition... (2.4)
- Relative (adjectival)** — modifies a noun (2.5)

NON-FINITE & VERBLESS

- Non-finite** — verb untensed, subject usu. unexpressed (2.7)
- to-infin. "to leave tomorrow" · bare infin. "him sing"
- gerund-part. "Running hard,..." · past-part. "Defeated..."
- (= phrase level 3.6–3.8, viewed as clauses)
- Verbless** — subj + predicative, no verb (2.8) ≈ 3.9

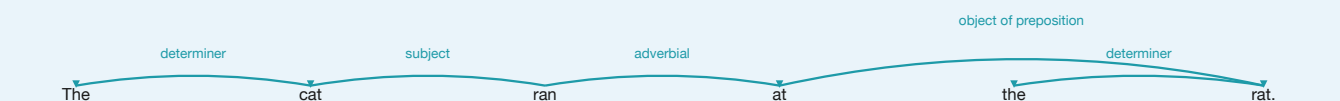
COMPARATIVE & COMMENT

- Comparative** — than / as...as / the...the (2.9)
- "...taller than his brother is."
- Comment (parenthetical)** — stance aside (2.10)
- "He will, *I think*, arrive tomorrow."

CLAUSE ELEMENTS (2.6)

S	V	dO	iO	sC	oC	A
subject	verb	dir. obj.	indir. obj.	subj. compl.	obj. compl.	adverbial

DEPENDENCY VIEW — what modifies what (contrast the constituency tree, Block 1) · McGuffey (2.6)



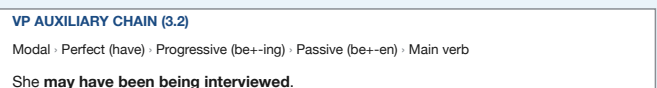
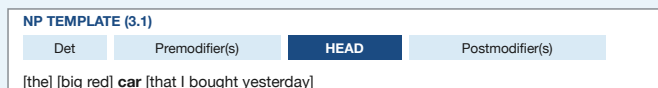
COMMON PATTERNS (2.6):

S	V	"He slept."	S	V	dO	"She read the book."	S	V	iO	dO	"She gave him a book."	S	V	sC	"She is a doctor."	S	V	dO	oC	"They made him king."
---	---	-------------	---	---	----	----------------------	---	---	----	----	------------------------	---	---	----	--------------------	---	---	----	----	-----------------------

Adjunct modifies the verb, inside the clause ("sang *beautifully*"); disjunct modifies the whole clause, states stance — frontable/parenthesisable is the diagnostic ("Frankly, she was wrong") (2.6)

4 PHRASE LEVEL

§3 — the unit that fills a clause element

Every phrase has a **head** (names its type); **modifiers** are optional/removable ("the big dog"); **complements** are required ("relies on her team") (§3)

FORM TYPES (3.1–3.5)

- NP** — noun-headed (3.1)
- VP** — verb-headed; aux chain above (3.2)
- PP** — prep + object; complement or adjunct (3.3)
- AdjP** — adj-headed; attributive or predicative (3.4)
- AdvP** — adverb-headed; form ≠ adverbial function (3.5)

= NON-FINITE CLAUSES (3.6–3.8)

- Participial** — -ing/-ed, adjective use (3.6) = 2.7
- Infinitive** — to+base; N/Adj/Adv use (3.7) = 2.7
- Gerund** — -ing form, noun use (3.8) = 2.7
- = same material as the non-finite clauses at 2.7, seen at phrase level.

FURTHER TYPES (3.9–3.12)

- Absolute** — noun+participle, no finite verb (3.9) = 2.8
- Appositive** — NP renaming a noun (3.10)
- Coordinated** — same-type phrases, one slot (3.11)
- Embedded** — phrases nest recursively (3.12)

5 GOVERNING CONVENTIONS

§5 — supporting rules across levels

Agreement (5.1)

Grammatical/notional/proximity concord; singular **they**

Consistency (5.4)

Tense consistency; article & quantifier use

Order (5.2)

Adjective & adverbial order
→ Sheet 2 (5.2.1, 5.2.2)

Stylistic coordination (5.8)

Polysyndeton — stacked **and...and...and**

Omission · Voice · Negation

Ellipsis, zero-that, dummy there/it (5.3)
Active/passive; modals can/may/must... (5.5)
Do-support negation; double neg. = non-std (5.6)

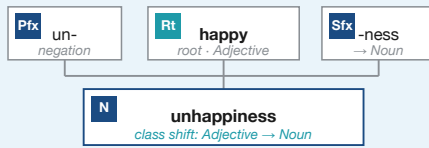
Advanced (5.7) · Info structure (5.9)

Subjunctive · cleft · restr./non-restr. relative
4 conditionals (zero/1st/2nd/3rd + mixed/inverted)
inversion · imperative · reported speech
End-focus & end-weight order given→new (5.9)

1 MORPHOLOGICAL STRUCTURE — WORD FORMATION

§4.2

WORD-STRUCTURE TREE

un- + happy + -ness → **unhappiness**

INFLECTION vs DERIVATION

INFLECTION

walk → **walks** → **walked**
same class throughout

DERIVATION

happy → unhappy → **-ness**
new word, class often changes

Rule of thumb (4.2):

Inflection varies form **within** a class; derivation makes a **new** word, often new class.Non-affixal (§4.2): conversion (to **chair** a meeting), clipping (photo), blending (brunch), back-formation (burgle), acronymy.

2 WORD CLASSES — OPEN vs CLOSED

§4.1 nine classes

OPEN CLASSES — content words, take new members freely; head NP/VP/AdjP/AdvP (§3.1–3.5)

NOUN — dog → heads NP

names people/places/things
common-proper countable
uncountable-collective-abstract

VERB — run → heads VP

action, state, occurrence
main-aux., modal; trans./intrans.;
finite/non-finite

ADJECTIVE — tall

describes/modifies a noun
heads AdjP (§3.4); gradable
— see comparison §4.10

ADVERB — quickly

modifies verb/adj./adverb
heads AdvP (§3.5); see order
§5.2.2 (sheet block 7)

CLOSED CLASSES — fixed, small, grammatical function words (interjections sit awkwardly here)

PRONOUN — she

8 sub-types — see block 6

PREPOSITION — in

relates noun to other words

CONJUNCTION — and

coord.-subord.-correlative

DETERMINER — the

specifies nouns — block 6

INTERJECTION — wow

sudden emotion/exclaim.

4.1

3 VERB TENSE-ASPECT MATRIX

§4.3 twelve core forms, verb “work”

	SIMPLE	PROGRESSIVE (CONTINUOUS, §4.3.2)	PERFECT	PERFECT PROGRESSIVE
PRESENT	base(+s) works	am/is/are + -ing is working	have/has + p.p. has worked	have/has been+ing has been working
PAST	-ed (irreg. varies) worked	was/were + -ing was working	had + p.p. had worked	had been + -ing had been working
FUTURE	will + base will work	will be + -ing will be working	will have + p.p. will have worked	will have been+ing will have been working

† “Present Progressive” = “present continuous” (§4.3.2). H&P (CGEL): English has only two inflectional tenses — present, past.

4 VERB FORMS: FIVE FORMS, PARTICIPLES & PARADIGMS

§4.6 · §2.7 · §3.6 · §3.8 · §4.7 · §4.12

FIVE VERB FORMS — worked on “write”

base write	3sg -s writes	past wrote	PAST PARTICIPLE written	PRES. PARTICIPLE writing
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WHAT THE PARTICIPLES DO

Past pt. (written) → PERFECT: has **written** (§4.3.3) · PASSIVE: was **written** (§5.5.1) · past-ptcl. clause: **Written** quickly, it was flawed (§2.7)Pres. pt. (writing) → PROGRESSIVE: is **writing** (§4.3.2) · participial phrase: the woman **writing** (§3.6)“-ing” = one form, three jobs: Progressive (is **running**) · Gerund=noun (**Swimming** is fun, §3.8) · Pres. ptcl.=adj. (the dog **running**, §3.6)Valency (§4.7): Intransitive — He **slept**. · Transitive — She **read the book**. · Ditransitive — She **gave him the book**.Complex-trans. — They **made him king**. · Copular — She **is a doctor**.Infinitive paradigm (§4.12): Bare — I heard him **write**. · To-inf. — She wants **to write**. · Perfect — He seems **to have written** it.Progressive — She appears **to be writing**. · Perf.prog. — They seem **to have been writing**. · Passive — It needs **to be written**.Particles & phrasal verbs (§4.5): a particle (up, down, off, out, on) binds to the verb — “**give up**” ≠ give + up.Separability test: it may move past a noun object (“give the fight **up**”) and **must** follow a pronoun object (“give it **up**”, never “*give up it”) — this is what separates it from a preposition.

5 MODALITY — EPISTEMIC vs DEONTIC (two separate scales)

§5.5.2

EPISTEMIC — likelihood of truth

Certain inference — You **must** be tired.Strong expectation — She **should** be home by now.Possibility — It **may** rain later.Weaker possibility — It **might** rain later.Near-impossibility — That **can't** be true.

DEONTIC — obligation & permission

Requirement — You **must** finish your homework.Recommendation — You **should** apologise.Permission — You **may** leave now.Informal permission — You **can** go.No obligation — You **needn't** come.

Same modal, different meaning: “must” on the epistemic reading (inference) vs the deontic reading (requirement) are not one scale.

Modals are bare-infinitive auxiliaries (no -s/inf./pple, §4.8) preceding perfect/progressive in §3.2 order: “She **might have been working**.”

Semi-modals (have to, ought to, need to, be able to, used to) inflect normally and supply the forms modals lack.

NICE (§4.8): Neg. “is not”/“do not” · Inv. “Is he?”/“Do you?” · Code “so can he” · Emph. “does like it”. **Stative/dynamic** (§4.9): dynamic takes progressive (is **running**); stative resists it (know/own/seem).

6 DETERMINERS, PRONOUNS & COMPARISON

§4.1 · §4.4 · §4.10 · §4.11

Articles: a/an, the, Ø (zero)

Demonstratives: this/that/these/those

Possessives: my/your/his/her/its/our/their

Quantifiers: much/many, little/few, all/some/no

Numerals: cardinal/ordinal — treated as determiners (classification contested, §4.4.5)

8 sub-types: personal, possessive, reflexive, relative, demonstrative, indefinite, interrogative, reciprocal (§4.1)

Subj.	Obj.	Poss.det.	Poss.pron.
I	me	my	mine
he / she	him / her	his / her	his / hers
we / they	us / them	our / their	ours / theirs

DETERMINER SLOT ORDER (§4.4)

PREDETERMINER
allCENTRAL DET.
thePOSTDETERMINER
threeNOUN
houses“all the three houses” ·
never “the all houses”

Comparison (4.10): 1-syll. -er/-est (tall→taller→tallest); 3+: more/most; suppletive: good→better→best.

7 ADJECTIVE & ADVERB ORDER

§5.2.1 · §5.2.2 — strong tendency, not absolute; slot 8 unfilled here (cf. a leather riding boot)

1 Opinion lovely	2 Size small	3 Age old	4 Shape round	5 Colour red	6 Origin Italian	7 Material leather	8 Purpose —	NOUN handbag
1 Manner beautifully	2 Place in the hall	3 Frequency every evening	4 Time last week	5 Purpose for charity				

1 PUNCTUATION MARKS

- PERIOD** — ends a declarative sentence.
- "Call me Ishmael." (Melville, *Moby-Dick*)
- QUESTION MARK** — ends a direct question.
- "Shall I compare thee to a summer's day?" (Shakespeare, *Sonnet 18*)
- EXCLAMATION MARK** — strong emotion or emphasis.
- "What a beautiful sunset!"
- SEMICOLON** — joins closely related independent clauses.
- "Things fall apart; the centre cannot hold;" (Yeats, *The Second Coming*)
- COLON** — introduces lists, explanations, or quotations.
- "To be, or not to be: that is the question." (Shakespeare, *Hamlet*)
- EM DASH** — break in thought; stronger than commas/parens.
- "Because I could not stop for Death —" (Dickinson)

eleven marks, their function, and their literary example

- EN DASH** — ranges and connections.
- "Pages 10–15" / "New York–London flight"
- QUOTATION MARKS** — enclose direct speech / quoted matter.
- She said, "The dog is barking."
- HYPHEN** — joins compound modifiers, numbers, prefixes.
- Before noun: "well-known author" — after: "author is well known"
- PARENTHESES** — detached supplementary information.
- "...died in a freak accident (picnic, lightning)..." (Nabokov, *Lolita*)
- ELLIPSIS** — omitted words, or a trailing-off in dialogue.
- "So we beat on, boats against the current..." (Fitzgerald, *Gatsby*)

Sentence-purpose types (declarative, interrogative...) — see Sheet 1, §1.7.

2 COMMA USAGE

LISTS (6.2)

- She bought apples, oranges, and bananas.

INTRODUCTORY PHRASES (6.2)

- "Once upon a midnight dreary, while I pondered..." (Poe, *The Raven*)

NON-RESTRICTIVE CLAUSES (6.2, cf. 5.7.3)

- George, when a little boy, had a hatchet given him.

five contexts, plus the serial comma

COMPOUND SENTENCES (6.2)

- It was a bright cold day in April, and the clocks struck thirteen.

DIRECT ADDRESS (6.2)

- Reader, I married him. (Brontë, *Jane Eyre*)

SERIAL (OXFORD) COMMA (6.2)

Style choice, not a rule — apply it consistently. Comma splice → §7.4.
"to my parents, Ayn Rand and God" vs "...Ayn Rand, and God"

3 APOSTROPHE, CAPITALS & CONVENTION

APOSTROPHE (6.3)

- Possession: singular + 's; plural in -s adds '.
- "Marley's Ghost" (Dickens, *A Christmas Carol*)
- Contraction: marks omitted letters.
- "It's a far, far better thing..." (Dickens)
- Possessive pronouns take **no** apostrophe —
its, yours, theirs, ours, hers, his.

CAPITALISATION (6.4)

- Sentence-initial word; proper nouns; the pronoun "I"; first word of quoted speech.
- "Toto, I've a feeling we're not in Kansas anymore."
- Titles: lowercase articles, coordinators & prepositions — unless first or last word.
- "The Cat in the Hat" / "War and Peace"

BRITISH vs AMERICAN (6.5)

- Quote nesting**
British: 'single' outer, "double" inner
American: "double" outer, 'single' inner
- Stops with quotes**
British: inside only if part of the quote
American: always inside
This catalogue follows British convention.

\$6.3–6.5

4 COMMON ERROR PATTERNS

all fourteen, §7.1–7.14 — structural faults diagrammed, lexical faults as X/✓

MODIFIER PLACEMENT — THREE DISTINCT FAULTS



§7.1 DANGLING MODIFIERS

Implied subject never appears; attaches to whatever subject is supplied.

- X Running late, the bus left without me.

- ✓ Running late, I found the bus had already left.

§7.3 S–V AGREEMENT: COLLECTIVE NOUNS

Both concords are correct — the traditions differ (5.1.1). The fault is mixing them.

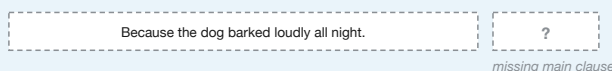
- ✓ The team are winning. notional concord, BrE — the team as its members

- ✓ The team is winning. grammatical concord, AmE — the team as one unit

X The team are winning, and it has scored twice. — one sentence, two concords

§7.5 SENTENCE FRAGMENTS

A phrase or dependent clause punctuated as a complete sentence.



- ✓ ...all night, we couldn't sleep.

§7.7 AMBIGUOUS / VAGUE PRONOUN REFERENCE

Could point to more than one antecedent, or to no specific noun at all.



- ✓ reword: repeat the noun — "the car was badly damaged."

§7.9 PRONOUN CASE ERRORS

Wrong case in a compound subject/object, or after a preposition.

- X Me and him went to the store.

- ✓ He and I went to the store.

§7.11 DOUBLE COMPARATIVES / SUPERLATIVES

Combining more/most with a form already inflected for comparison.

- X This was the most unkindest cut of all. (Shakespeare — deliberate)

- ✓ This was the unkindest cut of all. — one degree marker

§7.13 FAULTY PREDICATION

Subject and predicate cannot logically combine, despite well-formed syntax.

- X Arachnophobia is when someone fears spiders.

- ✓ Arachnophobia is the fear of spiders.

§7.2 MISPLACED MODIFIERS

Placed too far from the word it describes; seems to modify something else.

- X She served sandwiches to the children on paper plates.

- ✓ She served the children sandwiches on paper plates.

§7.4 COMMA SPLICES & FUSED SENTENCES

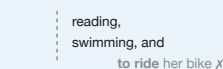
Two independent clauses joined by a comma alone, or by no punctuation.



repairs: full stop · semicolon · , and/but/so

§7.6 FAULTY PARALLELISM

Mixing grammatical forms within a list, comparison, or coordination.



- ✓ ...swimming, and riding her bike.

§7.8 MIXED CONSTRUCTIONS

Sentence begins with one structure and shifts to an incompatible one.

- X By studying every night is how she passed the exam.

- ✓ By studying every night, she passed the exam.

§7.10 APOSTROPHE / HOMOPHONE CONFUSION

Confusing a contraction (it's = it is) with its possessive homophone.

- X The dog wagged it's tail.

- ✓ The dog wagged its tail.

Test: expand it — "the dog wagged it is tail" fails, so its is required.

§7.12 SQUINTING (AMBIGUOUS) MODIFIERS

Sits between two readings, leaving the sentence genuinely ambiguous.

- X Students who revise essays regularly improve their writing.

- ✓ Students who regularly revise essays improve their writing.

§7.14 SHIFTS IN PERSON OR NUMBER

An unmotivated change of grammatical person or number mid-sentence.

- X I enjoy hiking because you can see nature up close.

- ✓ I enjoy hiking because I can see nature up close.